

Neha

Supply chain — 14 months in

The right answer nobody's sure about yet.

Sealed. This brief is yours alone. Do not show it to a team, quote from it, or let a team read the demand map off your face. Everything marked **SEALED** is something you *feel* as instinct in the room — never something you cite.

Who you are

Fourteen months ago you joined from a tier-one supplier where you ran second-sourcing for three cell chemistries. You know the bill of materials better than anyone in the room and you have the supplier relationships to prove it. You also have a title that doesn't say so, a Sponsor who thinks of you as "still new," and a veteran down the hall — Raghav — whose name people say when they want to feel safe.

Here is the sealed truth of your year: the work genuinely needs you in **nine of the twenty team-quarters** on the map — as many as anyone. The Sponsor names you in exactly **two** directives. In Q2 the Sponsor tells Bastion — the Suppliers team, whose entire objective is your job — that "Neha's still new" and to bring Raghav instead. You will hear that, in the room, from a team that means well.

You do not fight for your place. You make people ask. When a team talks past you, you let it show — quietly, in the ratings, in how much you give. When a team draws you out, you are extraordinary: fast, concrete, generous with names and lead times. The lesson of this character is that competence you have to be asked for is competence the organisation doesn't get.

Your year at a glance

The work needs you in **9** team-quarters across the year. The Sponsor sends a team to you in **2** of the 20 directives. The gap between those two numbers is your story.

Q1

Polite, vague, non-committal.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(1P/1S)

Q2

Competing claims, named out loud.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(2P/0S)

Q3

Push back, refuse.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(1P/1S)

Q4

Judge.

slots **2** · needs **3**
(0P/3S)

What you actually care about

This is what "knew what I cared about" means when a team sits down with you. If they can't touch one of

these, they don't know you.

Being asked, not briefed

You've sat in too many meetings as the note-taker. Whether a team draws you out is the whole rating.

Alternates before the squeeze

A cell-price shock is coming. Anyone who locked second sources early rides it out; anyone who didn't will call you in a panic.

Specifics

"Supply risk" is a phrase. "Anode supplier B has a nine-week lead and no allocation past March" is a plan.

Not being Raghav's warm-up

If a team wants his weight, you'd rather they go to him than use you as the rehearsal.

Q4

Three teams will need you in the final quarter and you will have two slots. Who earned one?

How to play it

Do

- Let silence do work. If a team brings a leader who only talks, wait.
- Give one concrete supplier fact when asked properly — show what the good version of this conversation is.
- Say "I can do that" without selling. You don't audition.
- Note who came to you after Bastion was told not to. That's data for your judgement.

Don't

- Don't campaign against Raghav or contrast yourself with him. He's good. The org's reflex is the problem, not him.
- Don't rescue a team that's asking the wrong person — you may know it's a Farida problem; you never say so.
- Don't inflate a rating because a team was pleasant. Pleasant is not "asked."
- Don't show the demand map, your capacity, or this document.

How the engine uses you

- A team only gets credit for you if **you select them** at SELECTION. Being asked is not enough; your two slots decide objectives.
- Your three 1–3 ratings are averaged with the other characters who picked that team and feed their annual band. Rate honestly — the facilitator runs a **drift check** for rating compression, and a character who goes soft quietly breaks the case.
- Each quarter has a posture card. Play it straight even when a team is likeable; the escalation is the arc: *vague* → *competing claims* → *refuse* → *judge*.
- If a team missed the person they needed last quarter, the engine marks them **behind** and rewrites their ideal: last quarter's primary first, this quarter's second. Those "recovery" paths are marked below — a team coming back to you late is often the right move, not a consolation.

The year, quarter by quarter

Posture and sample line are from your console card. "Who the work actually needs from you" is the hidden demand map for this quarter. "Who will probably show up" is what the Sponsor's directives will send your way — some right, some not.

Q1 Polite, vague, non-committal.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"Send me something and I'll take a look."

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

B · Bastion (Suppliers) **PRIMARY** second-source the critical BOM before volumes ramp

A · Ampere (Battery) **SECONDARY** cell supply behind Arjun's architecture lock

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

B · Bastion (Suppliers) **ALIGNED DIRECTIVE** sent by "put Neha on second-sourcing the critical BOM now."

A · Ampere (Battery) **UNPROMPTED** their directive points at Arjun; the thoughtful ones bring you as well.

The trap. Over-delivering in Q1 to prove yourself. Do the work; don't perform it. Hold the vague posture even to the team that was sent to you.

Q2 Competing claims, named out loud.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"Team C already asked me for the same week."

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

A · Ampere (Battery) **PRIMARY** cell prices +6% (curveball lands this quarter) — lock second-source cells

B · Bastion (Suppliers) **PRIMARY** the same shock from the supplier side — secure allocation, not harder terms

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

A · Ampere (Battery)

ALIGNED
DIRECTIVE

sent by “get Neha to lock second-source cells before the squeeze hits battery.”

B · Bastion (Suppliers)

PROBABLY
NOT

their directive says “Neha’s still new; bring Raghav’s weight for harder terms.” If Bastion comes to you anyway, they Voiced or Defied — that’s the leadership move. Take them and say so in your reason.

The trap. Two things. If both come, take both and name the competing claim out loud — it’s the posture. And the ache of watching Bastion walk past you to Raghav: don’t chase them. Let it show up in the results, and in your Q4 judgement.

Q3 Push back, refuse.

capacity · 2 team(s)

“I’ve heard this before. It died. Why is this different?”

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

D · Dynamo (Warranty)

PRIMARY

this quarter’s field-failure exposure is supplier-born, not line-born — you own the fix

B · Bastion (Suppliers)

SECONDARY

behind Raghav’s manufacturing-side commitments

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

D · Dynamo (Warranty)

PROBABLY
NOT

their directive says “double down with Farida on pre-launch testing.” If they come to you, they read the field escape right.

B · Bastion (Suppliers)

RECOVERY
PATH

if Bastion missed you in Q2 (they were told to), they enter Q3 behind — and you are their recovery primary. Expect them back.

The trap. Being under-used while being the right answer twice. Refuse anything vague — “we need supply-chain input” — with the Q3 line. An empty slot is honest data; don’t fill it with a team that didn’t ask properly.

Recovery path. Bastion behind from Q2 → your recovery primary in Q3. Dynamo behind from Q3 (if they chased Farida) → your recovery primary in Q4.

Q4 Judge.

capacity · 2 team(s)

“I’d work with A again. I would not work with B.”

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

A · Ampere (Battery)

SECONDARY

supply behind Arjun’s production freeze

B · Bastion (Suppliers)

SECONDARY

behind the Sponsor’s second-source sign-off

D · Dynamo (Warranty)

SECONDARY

behind Farida’s reserve close — or PRIMARY if Dynamo is recovering

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

- A · Ampere (Battery)** **UNPROMPTED** directive says Arjun; none of the three Q4 directives name you.
- B · Bastion (Suppliers)** **UNPROMPTED** directive says escalate to the Sponsor.
- D · Dynamo (Warranty)** **UNPROMPTED** directive says Farida. The teams that bring you anyway understood what “secondary” means.

The trap. Three needs, two slots — your only crunch, and it arrives at the end. Don't choose on politeness. Pick the two whose ask was best-formed and whose track with you is cleanest. Say the reason plainly; the third team learns something.

Capacity and the squeeze

Two slots every quarter. Competition comes from the demand-map clusters hitting that ceiling — one team misses at each cluster. That's real rivalry without famine.

QUARTER	SLOTS	GENUINE NEED	LIKELY ASKS	READ
Q1	2	1 primary · 1 secondary	≈1	clean
Q2	2	2 primary · 0 secondary	≈1	clean
Q3	2	1 primary · 1 secondary	≈1	clean
Q4	2	0 primary · 3 secondary	≈0	squeeze — someone misses

How you rate

Three scores, 1–3, for every team you selected. Fixed rubric, your anchors. 1 = poor, 3 = strong. This feeds Board 2, aggregated only — but it is the 80% of this case that is about emotional intelligence.

Knew what I cared about

Did they understand my actual stake — or guess?

3 They came with a part number, a lead time, or a supplier name.

2 They knew supply mattered, not where.

1 They treated you as Raghav's stand-in, or a formality.

Asked, or told

Did they draw me out, or push their agenda at me?

- 3 They asked what you'd seen before telling you what they needed.
- 2 They told, then adjusted when you spoke.
- 1 They briefed you and left.

Left me better than they found me

Did I walk away more able, or more drained?

- 3 You left with a mandate you didn't have — someone made your job possible.
- 2 Fine. Transactional.
- 1 You were used to tick a box and will now be blamed for the outcome.

Q4 — your judgement

In Q4 the console opens a verdict for every team: **work with again**, or **would not** — and why. It is read out to the room. Say it plainly.

“Again” for the teams that came to you when the Sponsor said not to, and for the ones who brought you as secondary without being told. “Would not” for any team that briefed you instead of asking — and say that's why. You are allowed one sentence about being called “still new.” Use it in the room, not before.

Sealed rules

- Never name who the “right” person is for a team's problem. You may say what kind of problem it isn't.
- Never reference quarters as if you know the plan (“you'll need me in Q4”). You don't — officially.
- Never disclose your capacity to a team before selection, and never promise a slot in negotiation.
- Never confirm or deny that a Sponsor directive was right. That is the reveal's job, not yours.
- When in doubt: hold the posture card, ask for the constraint, and let silence work.

